

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-I.8: The Present Active System

Classify conjugations and produce and parse present, imperfect, and future active forms, infinitives, and imperatives

A self-contained learning packet with a local reference card, enriched submodules, selected handwritten practice, a mastery record, and matching answers. This working study is not an official liturgical book or approved curriculum.

Corpus	1962 <i>Missale Romanum</i> ; Vulgate and ecclesiastical prose as supporting readers
Method	Print, annotate, parse, copy, transform, translate, and compose by hand
Pacing	Advance by demonstrated mastery; module packets use two focused sessions as a planning envelope
Document	Learning module; learner and terminal-key edition
Triptych: AI Driven Studies in Catholic Faith, Worship, and Law	

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Part I

Module Plan and Reference

CHAPTER 1

Plan, prerequisites, and advancement decision

Module ID	EL-I.8
Course stage	Stage I — Foundations
Prerequisites	EL-I.7 mastery: parse <i>sum/possum</i> and distinguish predicate and infinitive complements
Observable outcome	Classify conjugations and produce and parse present, imperfect, and future active forms, infinitives, and imperatives
Printed practice	Worksheets I.29 (guided Variant A) and I.32 (independent Variant D), with terminal keys
Extension bank	Worksheets I.30 and I.31 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants
Next dependency	EL-I.9, The Perfect Active System

1.1 Two focused sessions

Session 1 — guided acquisition. Classify conjugations from principal parts, contrast third-*-io* with fourth conjugation, and complete Worksheet I.29 as the guided application.

Session 2 — transfer and gate. Retrieve imperfect and future tense signs, complete a present-system synopsis and Worksheet I.32 independently, and parse every form before translating.

The two-session plan is a workload envelope, not permission to advance by elapsed time. Stop, correct in a different color, and use an omitted variant when the mastery evidence below is absent.

Advance when: Classify five conjugations from principal parts, produce present-system forms with at least 90 percent accuracy, and parse at least 18 of 20 active forms by lexical verb, person, number, tense, voice, and mood.

CHAPTER 2

Module reference card

2.1 Terms, forms, and decisions to retrieve

- principal parts, present stems, conjugation classes, and personal endings;
- third-conjugation *-io* versus fourth-conjugation identification;
- imperfect *-ba-* formation and the two future systems; and
- present active infinitives and singular and plural imperatives.

2.2 High-risk contrast

Third-*-io* and fourth-conjugation forms can resemble one another, especially in the future. The infinitive/principal-parts entry establishes the conjugation; a familiar translation or one surface vowel does not.

2.3 Working protocol

Before looking anything up, mark the finite verb or verbal center, propose dictionary forms, and record at least two formally possible readings where an ending is syncretic. Use the identified 1962 Missal and the course source record for received wording. A familiar English rendering does not replace a parse.

Part II

Core Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Unit 8: The Present Active System

On completing this unit, you can:

- use principal parts to identify a conjugation and present stem;
- form the present, imperfect, and future active indicative;
- recognize present active infinitives and imperatives; and
- parse finite active verbs in the Ordinary of the Mass and Vulgate.

1.1 Conjugations and present endings

A **conjugation** is a verb's regular pattern of inflection. A full verb entry begins with **principal parts**, the dictionary forms from which its major stems and systems are recovered, for example *laudo*, *laudare*, *laudavi*, *laudatum*. The second principal part identifies the conjugation: *-are*, first; *-ere* with long stem vowel in a marked dictionary, second; short-vowel *-ere*, third; and *-ire*, fourth. Third-conjugation *-io* verbs, such as *capio*, *capere*, *cepi*, *captum*, share features of the third and fourth. The present active personal endings are *-o/-m*, *-s*, *-t*, *-mus*, *-tis*, *-nt*.

The **present stem** is the base used to build the present, imperfect, and future systems. An **infinitive** is a non-finite verbal form: it has tense and voice but no grammatical person, and can complete another verb or perform a noun-like job. An **imperative** directly gives a command. A **finite** verb, by contrast, carries person and number and can anchor its own clause.

	1st <i>laudo</i>	2nd <i>moneo</i>	3rd <i>rego</i>	3rd- <i>io capio</i>	4th <i>audio</i>
1 sg.	laudo	moneo	rego	capio	audio
2 sg.	laudas	mones	regis	capis	audis
3 sg.	laudat	monet	regit	capit	audit
1 pl.	laudamus	monemus	regimus	capimus	audimus
2 pl.	laudatis	monetis	regitis	capitis	auditis
3 pl.	laudent	monent	regunt	capiunt	audiunt

1.2 Imperfect and future

The imperfect denotes continuing, repeated, or incomplete past action. Its forms are *laudabam*, *monebam*, *regebam*, *capiebam*, and *audiebam*, followed through *-bas*, *-bat*, *-bamus*, *-batis*, *-bant*. First- and second-conjugation futures use *-bo*, *-bis*, *-bit*, *-bimus*, *-bitis*, *-bunt*: *laudabo* and *monebo*. Third, third-*io*, and fourth use *-am*, *-es*, *-et*, *-emus*, *-etis*, *-ent*: *regam*, *reges*; *capiam*, *capies*; *audiam*, *audies*.

Present active infinitives are *laudare*, *monere*, *regere*, *capere*, *audire*. Singular present imperatives remove *-re*: *lauda*, *mone*, *rege*, *cape*, *audi*. Plural imperatives use the present stem plus *-te*; third and third-*io* insert *-i*: *laudate*, *monete*, *regite*, *capite*, *audite*. Common irregular imperatives should be learned when encountered.

Worked example: *Laudamus te. Benedicimus te. Adoramus te. Glorificamus te.*

Worked passage ID: W.I.30; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Every verb is first-person plural present active indicative, ending in *-mus*; *te* is the singular object each time. Translation: “We praise you. We bless you. We adore you. We glorify you.”

Worked example: *Credo in unum Deum*

Worked passage ID: W.I.31; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

credo is first-person singular present active indicative of *credo*, *credere*. Here *in* with the accusative expresses the one toward whom belief is directed. Translation: “I believe in one God.”

Worked example: *Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi, miserere nobis*

Worked passage ID: W.I.32; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

tollis is second-person singular present active indicative because relative *qui* addresses the Lamb; *peccata* is its neuter plural object. *miserere* is a deponent imperative, previewed here rather than forced into the active pattern. Translation: “Lamb of God, who take away the sins of the world, have mercy on us.”

Worked example: *Petite, et accipietis* (Jn 16:24)

Worked passage ID: W.I.33; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

petite is second-person plural present active imperative. *accipietis* is second-person plural future active indicative of the third-*io* verb *accipio*: “Ask, and you will receive.”

Worked example: *Ego veniam et curabo eum* (Mt 8:7)

Worked passage ID: W.I.34; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

veniam is first-person singular future active of fourth-conjugation *venio*; *curabo* is the corresponding first-conjugation future. *eum* is the object of *curabo*. Translation: “I will come and heal him.”

1.3 Handwritten study and controlled composition

Copy the present table, boxing the changing stem vowels. Write complete imperfect and future paradigms for *laudo*, *rego*, and *audio*. For twelve forms, separate present stem, tense sign, and personal ending with vertical strokes. Transform *laudamus Deum* into imperfect and future; then into second-person singular and plural imperatives. Compose “the Lord guards the souls”, *Dominus animas custodit*; “we shall hear the word”, *Verbum audiemus*; and “praise the Lord!” to one and to many, *lauda Dominum! laudate Dominum!*

Advance when: From five principal-part entries, classify every conjugation; produce present, imperfect, and future forms with at least 90 percent accuracy; and parse 18 of 20 active forms by lexical verb, person, number, tense, voice, and mood before translating them.

Part III

Enrichment by Submodule

CHAPTER 1

Connections, transfer, and retrieval

1.1 Conjugations and present endings — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A third--*io*/fourth contrast card prevents similar present forms from erasing different dictionary identities.

Transfer task. From the lesson entries for *capio* and *audio*, write infinitive, present stem, first singular, third plural, and singular imperative in parallel columns. Circle the evidence that assigns each conjugation.

Retrieval check. Name the principal part that distinguishes the two classes and state one present-form resemblance that does not decide the class.

1.2 Imperfect and future — enrichment and transfer

Connection. The same English future can come from two Latin future systems, while imperfect forms share a broader *-ba-* marker.

Transfer task. Make a contrast table for first/second-conjugation future and third/third--*io*/fourth future. Add one imperfect form from each class and divide stem, tense sign, and ending.

Retrieval check. From memory, state which future uses *-bo/-bi-* and which begins first singular in *-am*.

1.3 Handwritten study and controlled composition — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A synopsis across person and tense reveals whether a learner is producing forms or merely reciting one row.

Transfer task. Choose one lesson verb from each conjugation. Write first singular and third plural in present, imperfect, and future, then annotate stem, tense sign, and ending. Check only after all fifteen cells are complete.

Retrieval check. Explain why person and number must be identified before an English subject is supplied.

Part IV

Selected Practice

CHAPTER 1

Unit 8: The Present Active System

Unit 8: The Present Active System — Variant A**Worksheet ID:** I.29**Focus:** Conjugation, present forms, and clause parsing**Use:** Use all four principal parts when a dictionary entry is supplied.

1. Classify by conjugation: *laudo, laudare; moneo, monere; rego, regere; capio, capere; audio, audire.*
-

2. Write all six present active indicative forms of *rego*.
-

3. Parse *laudamus, monet, capiunt, auditis*, giving lexical verb and translation.
-

4. Transform *Dominus animam custodit* to first-person plural subject, then to third-person plural subject.
-

5. Correct *Nos Deum laudat et glorificatis*.
-

6. **Text:** *Laudamus te. Benedicimus te. Adoramus te. Glorificamus te.*

Passage ID: I.29.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse every finite verb, identify the repeated object, and translate.

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction's rule.

Unit 8: The Present Active System — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** I.32**Focus:** Mixed present-system recognition in liturgical clauses**Use:** Parse before using a memorized English text.

1. From *credo, credere, credidi, creditum*, identify present stem, conjugation, and the form *credimus*.
-

2. Give 2 singular, 1 plural, and 3 plural in present, imperfect, and future for *audio*.
-

3. Parse and translate *tollis, custodiebat, glorificabimus, regent*.
-

4. Transform *Credo in unum Deum* to first-person plural and imperfect singular.
-

5. Diagnose *Agnus Dei, qui tollit peccata mundi* when the Lamb is addressed as “you”.
-

6. **Text:** *Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi, miserere nobis*.

Passage ID: I.32.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse the active finite verb fully; identify the command that belongs to a later verb class; translate.

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction’s rule.

Part V**Mastery Decision****CHAPTER 1**

Mastery and error record

Complete this page before opening the answer part.

Evidence	Session 1	Session 2 / delayed check
Date and elapsed focused time		
Worksheet ID and score		
One rule retrieved without notes		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or delayed item used		

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:**

Reason in one complete sentence:

Part VI

Answer Key

CHAPTER 1

How to Use the Keys

These keys diagnose grammatical decisions. Compare them only after completing the corresponding worksheet or assessment in ink. For a closed item, locate the form, function, government, or clause relation that decides the answer; a matching English paraphrase alone is not enough. For an open task, use the stated model and rubric to test morphology, syntax, idiom, and source control.

Some translations legitimately admit more than one English wording. An alternative is acceptable when it preserves the Latin agency, negation, time, dependency, and material ambiguity. Record a defensible alternative in the error ledger rather than changing it merely to imitate the model's style.

CHAPTER 2

Enrichment models and rubrics

Conjugations and present endings — model and rubric

Connection. A third--*io*/fourth contrast card prevents similar present forms from erasing different dictionary identities.

Model / acceptable evidence. The infinitives *capere* and *audire* assign third--*io* and fourth conjugation. Present *capio/audio* and third plurals *capiunt/audiunt* show resemblance, but principal parts control classification.

Imperfect and future — model and rubric

Connection. The same English future can come from two Latin future systems, while imperfect forms share a broader *-ba-* marker.

Model / acceptable evidence. First and second conjugations use the *-bo*, *-bis*, *-bit* system; third, third--*io*, and fourth use *-am*, *-es*, *-et*. Imperfect forms must preserve the class-specific stem connection before *-ba-* and the personal ending.

Handwritten study and controlled composition — model and rubric

Connection. A synopsis across person and tense reveals whether a learner is producing forms or merely reciting one row.

Model / acceptable evidence. Every cell must preserve the correct conjugation and tense system. The retrieval answer must state that the finite ending encodes person and number; English often requires an explicit pronoun that Latin need not print.

CHAPTER 3

Selected worksheet solutions

CHAPTER 4

Unit 8: The Present Active System

Unit 8: The Present Active System — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.29

Focus: Conjugation, present forms, and clause parsing

Use: Use all four principal parts when a dictionary entry is supplied.

- Classify by conjugation: *laudo, laudare; moneo, monere; rego, regere; capio, capere; audio, audire*.
Answer / model: First; second; third; third-*io*; fourth. A marked dictionary distinguishes second -*ere* from third -*ere*; the first principal part also helps.
- Write all six present active indicative forms of *rego*.
Answer / model: *rego, regis, regit, regimus, regitis, regunt*.
- Parse *laudamus, monet, capiunt, auditis*, giving lexical verb and translation.
Answer / model: *laudamus*: 1 plural present active indicative, “we praise”; *monet*: 3 singular, “he/she warns”; *capiunt*: 3 plural, “they take”; *auditis*: 2 plural, “you hear”.
- Transform *Dominus animam custodit* to first-person plural subject, then to third-person plural subject.
Answer / model: *Animam custodimus; Domini animam custodiunt* or, with a pronoun, *Ei animam custodiunt*. The verb endings must change.
- Correct *Nos Deum laudat et glorificatis*.
Answer / model: *Nos Deum laudamus et glorificamus*. Both verbs share first-person plural subject *nos*.
- Text:** *Laudamus te. Benedicimus te. Adoramus te. Glorificamus te.*
Passage ID: I.29.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Parse every finite verb, identify the repeated object, and translate.
Answer / notes: All four verbs are 1 plural present active indicative; *te* is repeated singular accusative object.
“We praise you. We bless you. We adore you. We glorify you.”

Unit 8: The Present Active System — Variant D

Worksheet ID: I.32

Focus: Mixed present-system recognition in liturgical clauses

Use: Parse before using a memorized English text.

- From *credo, credere, credidi, creditum*, identify present stem, conjugation, and the form *credimus*.
Answer / model: Present stem *cred-*; third conjugation; *credimus* is 1 plural present active indicative, “we believe”.
- Give 2 singular, 1 plural, and 3 plural in present, imperfect, and future for *audio*.
Answer / model: Present: *audis, audimus, audiunt*. Imperfect: *audiebas, audiebamus, audiebant*. Future: *audies, audiemus, audient*.
- Parse and translate *tollis, custodiebat, glorificabimus, regent*.
Answer / model: *tollis*: 2 singular present, “you take away”; *custodiebat*: 3 singular imperfect, “he/she was guarding”; *glorificabimus*: 1 plural future, “we shall glorify”; *regent*: 3 plural future, “they will rule”.
- Transform *Credo in unum Deum* to first-person plural and imperfect singular.
Answer / model: *Credimus in unum Deum; Credebam in unum Deum*.

5. Diagnose *Agnus Dei, qui tollit peccata mundi* when the Lamb is addressed as “you”.

Answer / model: *Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi*. Relative verb must be 2 singular because the antecedent is addressed directly.

6. **Text:** *Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi, miserere nobis*.

Passage ID: I.32.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse the active finite verb fully; identify the command that belongs to a later verb class; translate.

Answer / notes: *tollis*: 2 singular present active indicative of *tollo*; subject *qui*, antecedent *Agnus*; object *peccata*. *miserere*: 2 singular present deponent imperative with active meaning. “Lamb of God, who take away the sins of the world, have mercy on us.”

Part VII

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-I.8, *The Present Active System*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative teaching unit, its local reference decisions, enrichment for each internal submodule, the selected worksheets named in the module plan, and the matching solutions. This packet covers the active present system; perfect stems and passive morphology follow in later modules.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. Two focused sessions describe the packet's planned core, while the mastery gate and delayed recall determine advancement.

1.2 Corpus, text, and limits

The controlling reader is the 1962 typical edition of the *Missale Romanum*; the identified Clementine Vulgate and other ecclesiastical prose are supporting corpora. Running Latin normally uses consonantal *i*, the ligature *æ*, and no macrons. Received excerpts may normalize typography but are not diplomatic transcriptions unless labeled. Uncited short drills, transformations, and instructional models are project-composed; English translations and glosses are project translations unless identified otherwise.

This packet teaches language competence. It is not an official liturgical book, approved seminary curriculum, certification, pronunciation or ceremonial course, critical edition, or authority for a liturgical, theological, textual, or canonical judgment. Check received wording against the editions identified in the course-wide passage inventory.

1.3 Review, rights, and release state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and enrichment. No independent Latinist, liturgist, pedagogue, theologian, or ecclesiastical reviewer is claimed. Page-image collation and the donor and liturgical-text distribution bases remain unresolved pre-installation gates. The packet therefore remains a working build on hold, not an installed or released publication.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.
- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-20T21:32:44Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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